ZHANLI LI (李展利)

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EDUCATION

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law *September 2023 – June 2027*
Wenlan School of Business (Honors College), B.Sc. in Digital Economy
Weighted Avg: 93.73/100 Rank: 2/80 2025 National Scholarship
Research Interests: LLMs, Agentic Training, Deep Learning, Causal Inference

PUBLICATIONS

Zhanli Li, Huiwen Tian, Lvzhou Luo, Yixuan Cao, Ping Luo. *DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search. KDD 2027* (CCF-A), **Resubmit**. [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Yixuan Cao, Lvzhou Luo, Ping Luo. *Navigating Large-Scale Document Collections: MuDABench for Multi-Document Analytical QA. ACL 2026 Findings* (CCF-A). [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Zichao Yang. *ESG Rating Disagreement and Corporate Total Factor Productivity: Inference and Prediction. Finance Research Letters*, vol. 78, p. 107127, 2025. (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9). [**First Author**]

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

NVIDIA Nemotron Model Reasoning Challenge ***Silver Medal*** *June 2026*
On a new **abstract puzzle reasoning benchmark** built around NVIDIA Nemotron open reasoning models, we explored ways to improve reasoning accuracy under the competition-required **LoRA fine-tuning** setting. We built an **agentic reasoning** framework to iteratively solve unsolved puzzles, then organized the induced rules into reusable **solvers** to preserve prefix-reasoning consistency and answer verifiability, achieving a score of **0.86**.

▷ **Kaggle Leaderboard Silver Medal**, ranked **128/4355** globally on the final leaderboard.

Agentic Training for Real-World Data Analysis‡ *March 2026 – Present*
Role: Project Leader
Existing evaluation benchmarks for data analysis agents typically rely on **fixed reference answers**, making it difficult to capture **non-canonical yet valuable insights** generated in open-ended analytical settings, thereby systematically underestimating their true capability. To address this, we construct a **large-scale interactive data lake environment** that supports autonomous exploration under realistic data distributions. Built on this environment, we train **Qwen3.5-9B** as a **verifier agent** on **24 A100 GPUs** to perform **fine-grained verification** of each insight produced by the data agent, assessing both correctness and analytical value. We further integrate the trained verifier into an **iterative agent harness**, forming a "**generate-verify-feedback**" loop that continuously yields **high-value insights** in real-world scenarios.

▷ Selected for the **Zhongguancun Academy Shenlan Program**; intended submission to *ICLR 2027*.

DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search† *October 2025 – February 2026*
Role: Project Leader
Existing agentic search frameworks often treat long documents as flat chunk collections, ignoring native **hierarchical structures** and **sequential logic**. We propose **DeepRead**, a structure-aware document reasoning agent that preserves layout fidelity via OCR, constructs **paragraph-level coordinates**, and equips the LLM with two synergistic tools: **Retrieve** and **ReadSection**. This induces an emergent "locate-then-read" reasoning paradigm, significantly mitigating context fragmentation issues inherent in conventional retrieval. Across four benchmarks covering diverse document types, DeepRead outperforms **Search-o1** style agentic search baselines by an average of **10.3%**.

▷ **Resubmit to** *KDD 2027 (CCF-A)*. The preprint was reported by the prominent tech media **New Wisdom (新智元)** and received over 130 saves on Xiaohongshu.

MuDABench: Multi-Document Analytical QA Benchmark and Multi-Agent Framework† *April 2025 – December 2025*
Role: Project Leader
Large-scale document collections contain rich knowledge, yet scalable multi-document analytical QA across **thousands** of long documents remains challenging. We constructed one of the **largest** multi-document analytical QA benchmarks to date (**80k+** pages, **332** analytical questions, **4,964** structured intermediate facts) using **distant supervision** and expert verification, enabling systematic evaluation of multi-document retrieval, cross-document aggregation, and numerical reasoning. Experiments reveal that standard retrieval services struggle in this setting: OpenAI's **File Search** achieves a very low best accuracy. Our proposed **Multi-Agent** workflow raises this substantially. Further error analysis indicates that the primary bottleneck lies in the stability and high-precision localization of **single-document information extraction**.

▷ **Published in** *ACL 2026 Findings (CCF-A).*

†Conducted under the supervision of Associate Professors Yixuan Cao and Ping Luo, Key Laboratory of Intelligent Information Processing, Institute of Computing Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences

‡Conducted under the supervision of Assistant Professor Wentao Zhang, Peking University & Zhongguancun Academy

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

Beijing Paoding Technology Co., Ltd. — Research Dept. *June 2025 – February 2026*
Role: AI Research Intern **Mentors:** Ping Luo, Yixuan Cao
Project: Improving Context Retrieval in Production-Grade RAG Systems

Leveraged the company's proprietary **document parsing** model PDFlux and integrated its outputs into the commercial RAG product ChatDOC, focusing on mitigating **context-missing** issues introduced by reranker-based retrieval and improving retrieval completeness and ranking quality in complex document scenarios. The system has been deployed in production environments at several **top-tier financial institutions**, markedly enhancing operational efficiency.

SELECTED AWARDS

China National Scholarship *November 2025*
Highest academic honor for undergraduates in China (Top 0.2%).

China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling *November 2025*
First Prize (Team Leader, Top 3%).

Hunan Province Outstanding Student (High School) *April 2023*
Awarded to the top 0.1% of high school students in Hunan Province.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & SERVICE

Languages: Chinese (native), English (CET-4: 522, CET-6: 508)
Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, LaTeX, Markdown
Tools: Docker, SSH, tmux, Ubuntu
Libraries & Frameworks: ms-swift, vllm, verl, llamaindex, transformers, torch, sklearn, pandas, numpy
Academic Service: Independent Reviewer for *Finance Research Letters*